

What it actually costs, side by side

Sources: Claude pricing page (claude.com/pricing, September 15, 2026) for Claude Pro. ChatGPT Plus price: verify at openai.com/chatgpt/pricing. Virtual assistant ranges: 2026 industry pricing guides (Wishup, Cherry Assistant, Virtustant, Ocean's Talent); ranges vary by source, and these are the overlapping bands.

Option	Monthly cost	What you get	What you do not get
Free ChatGPT or Claude	\$0	Everything built this morning: Projects, saved voice, drafts, research briefs, a daily scheduled nudge (ChatGPT)	Usage limits. No inbox access. Nothing sends itself.
One paid plan (ChatGPT Plus about \$20; Claude Pro \$20, or \$17 a month billed annually)	about \$20	More usage. ChatGPT: 5 scheduled tasks with exact times. Claude: Cowork with scheduled tasks.	Still does not send email for you
Both paid	about \$40 (about \$480 a year)	A second opinion on everything, and both tools' extras	Same
Offshore virtual assistant, part time (about 20 hours a week)	\$350 to \$1,300	A person who can call suppliers, use your CRM, and think	Your time to hire, train, and manage. Time zone. Turnover.
US-based virtual assistant, part time	\$1,200 to 3,000(25 to \$50 an hour)	Same, in your time zone, with travel experience if you are lucky	Same management load, and the price
A built automation (the chaser you just saw)	One-time setup, then a small monthly tool cost	Watches, drafts, sends after your approval, never forgets	Judgment. Phone calls. Anything not in the spec.

What none of these do, including the humans: decide for you, hold the client relationship, or be accountable at 2 AM when the flight cancels. That is the job clients pay you for. These three take the parts they do not.

The chaser: free tier versus built for you

It drafts. You approve. Nothing reaches a client without your eyes on it.

	Free tier	Built for you
Drafts the nudge in your voice	Yes	Yes
Reminds you on a schedule	Yes (ChatGPT tasks or a calendar)	Yes
Watches your inbox or CRM for quotes going quiet	No	Yes
Sends after you approve, from your address	No	Yes
Cost	\$0	One-time setup, then a small monthly tool cost. Ask us for the range.

Questions: support@empowerment-ai.com